Position Paper

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Country: France
Delegate: Jules Kitto-Astrop
Committee: The International Criminal Police Organization. h
Agenda: The Question of Combatting Human Trafficking Networks Across Western Europe with an Emphasis on Paris

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In a world where digital networking thrives, physical gatherings have diminished, and desperation continues to suffocate billions, traffickers exploit these facts as well as individuals to meet their own needs. Dismantling cross-border and international trafficking networks is one of the largest and most difficult mandates of INTERPOL; and cc without international cooperation in identifying at-risk regions and groups, any criminal investigation network is rendered obsolete. Thus, all nations must come together to bridge the gaps in knowledge and understanding across the world. Today, the delegation of France remains horrified by the annual registered reports of over 10,000 victims of trafficking in Europe, and demands for all members to demolish all forms of exploitative services through the criminalization of purchasing such services. The delegation of France believes that the current methods of dismantling networks, while not completely ineffective, lack multi-cultural nuance and understanding as well as the absence of public education initiatives that can and will play a big role in preventing victims from ever being coerced or exploited. The delegation of France is eager to collaboratively draft international legislation that benefits all nations and individuals while holding those – who have committed heinous crimes – responsible.

Despite France being listed as a Tier 1 country by the US Department of State, the delegation firmly believes that further measures must be taken to combat the harmful decline in convictions and identifications that do not reflect the steady and even increasing number of human trafficking cases. INTERPOL has developed several effective mechanisms to combat trafficking however issues regarding implementation still remain. Systems such as the Purple Notice for Modus Operandi tracking is a highly innovative method of informing international sectors of major criminal networks while gathering necessary information to dismantle them. INTERPOL's I-24/7 database also enables immediate information sharing across the world which ensures police are able to keep up with the criminal networks using direct communication. France strongly affirms such information sharing and further encourages the strengthening of SLTD databases to utilise AI tools to enhance pattern recognition with extraordinary standards for neutrality to mitigate algorithmic bias seen across AI-based judicial and healthcare digital systems. Over the past 2 years, the delegation of France has committed to implementing various measures to combat, identify, and resolve the trafficking and exploitation of humans through the development and adoption of the National Plan to Fight Exploitation and Human Trafficking (2024-2027) introduced by MIPROF, which details the key statistics relevant to the development of solutions such as; improving public knowledge and awareness, strengthening survivor support programs, reassessing legislation to ensure justice is served to the appropriate extent, combating the exploitative factors such as poverty, and collaborating with nations along the trade route to dismantle networks. The delegation of France also acknowledges the internal struggles that we must resolve to reduce risks of trafficking for vulnerable populations such as minors living in Mayotte. While Mayotte is not connected to France by land, it still remains under French jurisdiction and is thus our responsibility to protect. As stated by the UN, France has turned a blind eye to the victims in Mayotte and has violated human rights for many children on the island due to the vulnerability posed by a lack of a guardian and forced criminality or exploitation. According to the French Assembly report of 2020, Mayotte is home to over 4,000 unaccompanied minors, whose parents were arrested, killed, or exploited. The delegation of France firmly condemns the lack of action taken in regards to the vulnerable populations in Mayotte and strongly encourages the provision of funding from all developed nations to islands and smaller countries such as Mayotte, whose civilians are highly susceptible to exploitation either through forced labour or sex services due to desperation. The delegate of France is committed to rectifying these errors and working towards a world free of exploitation and filled with empathetic justice. To be in the center of human trafficking networks is a terrifying reality France faces every day but with the support provided – through organizations such as the Secours Catholique who aid migrants and irregular residents in gaining legal support and social guidance to transition towards a legal and approved status of migration in France – the nation is capable of mitigating the damages to humanity caused by the trafficking of human beings across the world.

The delegation of France remains ready to propose countless solutions that aim to address every aspect of the human smuggling and trafficking sector. Firstly, France believes in the implementation of international legislation specifically stating the definition of human trafficking and the illegality of the act across all nations as well as the specified extent of punishment for the violation of fundamental human rights. Secondly, the continued use of algorithms to identify victims or trafficker ads must be continuously developed with new information gathered as INTERPOL successfully dismantles cross-regional trafficking networks – INTERPOL will use the aforementioned data to update the International Child Sexual Exploitation (ICSE) database with new indicators such as petty criminality. Thirdly, the delegation of France aims to place a heavy emphasis on the humanity of victims through several victim laws and programs. France believes all victims across the globe should be entitled up to three months of recovery time after being separated from their traffickers, during which they will be provided with government mandated assistance in housing, job searches, achieving familial contact, and psychological support. In order to prevent risking damage to the individual's mental state or physical safety, all information provided during the 3 month period must be done through a psychological professional who can aid in memory techniques. Fourthly, Victims convicted of forced criminality must not be prosecuted for such crimes committed under duress – this strategy also aims to mitigate the fear in victims regarding the judicial systems. Lastly, the victims may choose to return to their home land or achieve citizenship through the informing on routes for trafficking, identities of traffickers, or methods of trafficking. Furthermore, the delegation of France affirms the increased pursuit of labour trafficking as suggested by the US Department of State. The delegation further urges all nations to implement a national reporting mechanism to standardize care through transparency, moreover, the expansion of what is deemed a valid claim of human trafficking to include those by social, civil society, and healthcare workers will make a great impact on conviction rates and successful rescues of victims. Finally, The delegation of France is honored to be in a position to aid in the dismantling of human trafficking networks and will stop at nothing to ensure all civilians safety.

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